

Hub app listing says users can view phones, tablets, headphones and accessories on a map, play a sound if the device is nearby, and remotely secure or erase a lost device.

Set it up before the phone disappears. Also teach one trusted family member how to help you access it from another device. During panic, memory becomes unreliable.

Step-by-step: prepare Find Hub

- Open Settings.
- Search Find Hub or Find My Device, depending on your phone.
- Make sure the feature is turned on.
- Confirm the correct Google account is signed in.
- Keep location enabled.
- Open the Find Hub app or web page from another device once and confirm your phone appears.
- Check that you know how to play sound, secure device and erase device.

Do not wait for theft to learn the menu.

Use Android theft protection

Google's Android help page also explains how to turn on Theft Detection Lock, Offline Device Lock and Failed Authentication Lock from Settings > Google > All services > Theft protection, though support varies by device.

Step-by-step: enable theft protection

- Open Settings.
- Tap Google.
- Tap All services.
- Tap Theft protection.
- Turn on Theft Detection Lock, if available.
- Turn on Offline Device Lock.
- Turn on Failed Authentication Lock, if available.
- Turn on Remote Lock, if your device supports it.
- Confirm your recovery phone number and Google account details are correct.

If a setting is missing or greyed out, your device may not support it yet.

Advanced Protection is for higher-risk users

Google's Android help says turning on Advanced Protection provides the strongest security and privacy features to protect against online attacks, harmful apps and data risks. This is not necessary for everyone. Stronger protection may create extra friction. But if your phone contains sensitive sources, unpublished work, confidential documents or high-risk accounts, friction may be worth it.

Search Advanced Protection in Settings. Read what your device says before enabling it. Security features are best used with understanding, not bravado.

Build an emergency stolen-phone plan

Security is not complete until you know what to do when things go wrong.

If your phone is stolen, first try Remote Lock or Find Hub from another device. Google's Remote Lock page says users can lock a lost or stolen Android device by entering the phone number, provided Remote Lock is on; if the device is offline, the screen will lock once it comes online.



Then call your mobile operator to block the SIM, especially the number linked to banking and UPI. Use another device to change your Google account password if needed. Log out of sensitive sessions. Contact your bank if UPI or banking apps were active. File a police complaint if required. Use Find Hub erase only when you believe recovery is unlikely or data risk is high, because erase may affect further tracking.

Emergency checklist

- Lock the phone remotely.
- Block the SIM.
- Change Google password if needed.
- Remove the device from important accounts.
- Contact banks and UPI apps.
- File a complaint with IMEI details.
- Inform close contacts if scams may be attempted from your number.

This plan should exist before theft, not after.

The weekly security habit

Once a week, spend ten minutes on security. Update apps. Check for system updates. Run Play Protect. Review unknown app install permissions. Remove unused apps. Check Find Hub. Look at recent account security alerts. Make sure backups are running.

A secure Android phone does not make you invincible. It makes you harder to fool, harder to unlock, harder to infect and easier to recover from disaster. That is enough. **d**